

political parties, the Left and the BJP, played spoilsport. But what do they have to say now?

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Fair Trial

Most of the judges in the higher courts are appointed from a list of practising lawyers. However, some restraint must be exercised while making such appointments ("Judges on Trial", September 22). To ensure a free and fair judiciary, there should be a systematic screening process for the selection of the judges.

V.K. TANGRI, *on e-mail*

The immunity enjoyed by the judges should be removed. They should be liable for prosecution for their wrong-doings just like any other accused who face trial and also punishment, if found guilty. If the judges are exempted from trial and punishment for their crime, there's no way we can end corruption in the judicial system. The number of unscrupulous judges is on the rise and it is time they are dealt with sternly, or else people would lose faith in judiciary.

A. SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

Visa Trouble

Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi is a man with a mission, a leader with conviction and a manager with vision ("Yearning for Visa Power", September 22). Condemning him as the man behind the communal riots is utter nonsense and false propaganda advanced by Muslim fanatics. And denying Modi a visa

is an insult to Indian democracy.

VINOD C. DIXIT, *on e-mail*

Judgement at Last

Sanjeev Nanda's conviction in the BMW case will serve as a deterrent to those wanting to influence judiciary, in any way ("Driving Home a Point", September 15). But the judicial process should be expedited, only then such efficacies will be exemplary.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

Acting Tough

Mamata Banerjee's protest in Singur was her way to get even with the Left Government ("The Curse of Didigiri", September 22). She succeeded in doing so, but at the cost of the state's progress and development. Tata's pullout from Singur is justified, but it will have a cascading effect on the employment opportunities for the rural educated unemployed youths.

BAL GOVIND, *on e-mail*



Years Ago in India Today

NOVEMBER 1-15, 1978



The Cult of Virginity

Majority of college girls in four major metropolitan cities have never kissed a man on the lips. They firmly believe that premarital sex "is wrong" and that "most boys want to marry a virgin". Only a tiny minority learned how babies were born before they were 14 and even today, most of them do not know what VD stands for. On the whole, an average college girl is conservative, conventional and cautious in all matters relating to sex, and espouses views similar to her mother's. The boys are no different—their fringe liberalism being more than compensated for by a distressing combination of intolerance and ignorance. Those were the major findings of a survey conducted by the Indian Market Research Bureau (IMRB). IMRB's researchers interviewed 604 college students and the interviews were kept as informal as possible and three broad questions were asked: those dealing with the awareness of VD, and birth control; attitudes towards virginity, divorce, and homosexuality, and actual experience of kissing, petting, or intercourse.

—Vr Sanghi

BEST VS WORST



RUBEN SINGH

By striking the right balance between agriculture and industrial growth, development can be assured and this has been exemplified by Punjab ("State of the States", September 22). Kudos to Himachal Pradesh for its astounding development in all spheres.

ROHIT KUMAR, *Delhi*

The survey was nothing but a celebration of non-performance. Punjab, which scored 3.16 out of 10, was declared the best state. Instead, INDIA TODAY should have focused on the best of the worst. It would have made some sense, at least.

DR VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

The survey was an eye-opener to see and judge the state of the states in the country and also of the various MPs and MLAs who represent us in Parliament and assemblies, respectively.

MADHU R.D. SINGH, *on e-mail*

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